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User Color Schemes

Create your own color schemes to personalize Noctalia with your favorite colors.

Creating a Color Scheme

1. Create the Scheme Directory

Create a folder for your scheme in `~/.config/noctalia/colorschemes/`:

```
~/.config/noctalia/colorschemes/MyScheme/
```

2. Create the Scheme File

Create a JSON file with the same name as your folder:

`~/.config/noctalia/colorschemes/MyScheme/MyScheme.json`

```
{  
  "dark": {
```

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```
    "mOnPrimary": "#272822",  
    "mSecondary": "#66d9ef",  
    "mOnSecondary": "#272822",  
    "mTertiary": "#f92672",  
    "mOnTertiary": "#272822",  
    "mError": "#f92672",  
    "mOnError": "#272822",  
    "mSurface": "#272822",  
    "mOnSurface": "#f8f8f2",  
    "mHover": "#3a3a32",  
    "mOnHover": "#f8f8f2",  
    "mSurfaceVariant": "#3e3d32",  
    "mOnSurfaceVariant": "#a6e22e",  
    "mOutline": "#75715e",  
    "mShadow": "#272822",  
    "terminal": {  
      "background": "#272822",  
      "foreground": "#f8f8f2",  
      "cursor": "#f8f8f2",  
      "cursorText": "#272822",  
      "selectionBackground": "#f8f8f2",  
      "selectionForeground": "#272822",  
      "normal": {  
        "black": "#272822",  
        "red": "#f92672",  
        "green": "#a6e22e",  
        "yellow": "#f4bf75",  
        "blue": "#66d9ef",  
        "magenta": "#ae81ff",  
        "cyan": "#a1efe4",  
        "white": "#f8f8f2"  
      },  
      "bright": {  
        "black": "#75715e",  
        "red": "#f92672",  
        "green": "#a6e22e",
```

```
"yellow": "#f4bf75",
```

```
"blue": "#66d9ef",
```

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```
"white": "#f9f8f5"
```

```
}
```

```
}
```

```
},
```

```
"light": {
```

```
  "mPrimary": "#a6e22e",
```

```
  "mOnPrimary": "#f8f8f2",
```

```
  "mSecondary": "#66d9ef",
```

```
  "mOnSecondary": "#f8f8f2",
```

```
  "mTertiary": "#f92672",
```

```
  "mOnTertiary": "#f8f8f2",
```

```
  "mError": "#f92672",
```

```
  "mOnError": "#f8f8f2",
```

```
  "mSurface": "#f8f8f2",
```

```
  "mOnSurface": "#272822",
```

```
  "mHover": "#e6e1dc",
```

```
  "mOnHover": "#272822",
```

```
  "mSurfaceVariant": "#e6e1dc",
```

```
  "mOnSurfaceVariant": "#272822",
```

```
  "mOutline": "#a6e22e",
```

```
  "mShadow": "#d8d8d8",
```

```
  "terminal": {
```

```
    "background": "#f8f8f2",
```

```
    "foreground": "#272822",
```

```
    "cursor": "#272822",
```

```
    "cursorText": "#f8f8f2",
```

```
    "selectionBackground": "#272822",
```

```
    "selectionForeground": "#f8f8f2",
```

```
    "normal": {
```

```
      "black": "#f8f8f2",
```

```
      "red": "#f92672",
```

```
      "green": "#a6e22e",
```

```
      "yellow": "#f4bf75",
```

```
      "blue": "#66d9ef",
```

```
      "magenta": "#ae81ff",
```

```
      "cyan": "#a1efe4",
```

```
"white": "#272822"
},
```

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```
"red": "#f92672",
"green": "#a6e22e",
"yellow": "#f4bf75",
"blue": "#66d9ef",
"magenta": "#ae81ff",
"cyan": "#a1efe4",
"white": "#1e1e19"
}
}
}
}
```

3. Select Your Scheme

- 1. Restart Noctalia to load the new scheme
- 2. Open **Settings → Color Scheme**
- 3. Select your scheme from the list

Color Properties

Each scheme needs both dark and light variants with these colors:

Property	Description
mPrimary	Primary accent (buttons, links, highlights)
mOnPrimary	Text/icons on primary surfaces
mSecondary	Secondary accent color
mOnSecondary	Text/icons on secondary surfaces
mTertiary	Tertiary accent color

Property	Description
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mError	Error/warning color
mOnError	Text/icons on error surfaces
mSurface	Main background color
mOnSurface	Primary text color
mHover	Hover state background
mOnHover	Text on hover surfaces
mSurfaceVariant	Secondary background (cards, panels)
mOnSurfaceVariant	Text on surface variants
mOutline	Borders and dividers
mShadow	Shadow color

Terminal Colors

The terminal section defines colors for terminal emulators (Foot, Ghostty, Kitty, Alacritty, Wezterm):

Property	Description
background	Terminal background
foreground	Default text color
cursor	Cursor color
cursorText	Text under cursor

Property	Description
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selectionForeground	Selected text color
normal	Normal colors
bright	Bright variants of the normal colors

Terminal Colors

Good terminal colors are essential for syntax highlighting. Test your scheme with code to ensure readability.

Tips

Color Selection

- **Start simple** - Pick 2-3 core colors that define your scheme
- **Ensure contrast** - Text should be readable on all backgrounds
- **Test both modes** - Dark and light variants should both work well

Adapting Existing Themes

Popular themes like Dracula, Nord, or Catppuccin can be adapted:

1. Find the theme's color palette
2. Map colors to Noctalia's properties
3. Adjust for good contrast

Tools

- [Coolors.co](#) - Color palette generator
- [WebAIM Contrast Checker](#) - Verify accessibility

Quickstart: User Color Schemes

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Want to share your color scheme with the community?

Submit it to the [noctalia-colorschemes](#) repository!

Troubleshooting

Issue	Solution
Scheme not appearing	Check folder/file naming match exactly
Colors not applying	Validate JSON syntax
Poor contrast	Use contrast checker tools
Terminal colors wrong	Verify all normal and bright colors are defined